

**Nantong Linens**

# **How to Buy Hotel Linens from China: The Complete 2026 Procurement Guide**

The Complete 2026 Procurement Guide for Hotel Buyers

*A step-by-step procurement guide for hotel buyers sourcing bed sheets, towels, and bath linens from China. Covers MOQ, pricing, shipping, and quality control -- based on factory-side experience in the Dieshiqiao textile cluster.*

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## Step 1: Define Your Specifications Before Contacting Suppliers

The single biggest mistake we see buyers make: sending vague inquiries like 'I need hotel bed sheets, please quote.' Suppliers receive hundreds of these daily and will either ignore them or quote wildly different products.

Before contacting anyone, nail down these specifications:

| Specification         | What to Define                               | Example            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Fiber Composition     | 100% cotton, poly-cotton blend, bamboo       | 100% combed cotton |
| Thread Count (Sheets) | 200TC to 1200TC; 300-400 is hotel sweet spot | 300TC percale      |
| GSM (Towels)          | 300 GSM (budget) to 700 GSM (luxury)         | 550 GSM zero-twist |
| Weave Type            | Percale, sateen, jacquard, waffle            | Percale            |
| Sizes                 | Twin, Full, Queen, King + depth              | King 78x80+16 inch |
| Color / Finish        | White, ivory, custom dye; mercerized         | White, mercerized  |
| Packaging             | Individual polybag, bulk, retail-ready       | Individual polybag |

Having these specs written down before you send a single inquiry will immediately signal to suppliers that you are a serious buyer -- and will give you comparable quotes across factories.

## Step 2: Understand Minimum Order Quantities (MOQ)

MOQ is the most common friction point for first-time buyers. Here's what to expect:

- Bed sheets: Most factories require 200-500 sets per size per color. Some will accept 100 sets with a small surcharge (5-10%).
- Towels: 500-1000 pieces per type is standard. Bath towels, hand towels, and washcloths often count as separate MOQs.
- Duvet covers & pillowcases: Similar to sheets -- 200-500 sets per size.

Smaller factories or those in Dieshiqiao's wholesale corridors may accept lower MOQs (50-100 sets) but at higher per-unit prices. The tradeoff between MOQ and unit price is where local knowledge pays off -- knowing which mills are flexible on minimums and which are not. A manufacturer running its own line can

usually accept the lower trial quantity, because there is no third-party minimum to satisfy.

### Step 3: Request and Compare Quotes

When requesting quotes, send the same specification document to 3-5 factories. Key items to compare:

1. Unit price (in USD, FOB Shanghai or Ningbo unless DDP is specified)
2. Payment terms (30% deposit / 70% before shipment is standard; L/C at sight for larger orders)
3. Sample policy (free pre-production sample vs. paid; who covers courier)
4. Lead time (typically 25-45 days after sample approval)
5. Packaging included vs. extra charge

A quote that is significantly lower than others usually means lower-grade fabric, lighter GSM, or thinner packaging -- not a better deal.

### Step 4: Sample Before You Commit

Never, ever place a production order without approving a physical sample. Here's the typical sampling workflow:

- Pre-production sample (PPS): Factory produces 1-2 pieces to your spec. Cost: \$30-80 + courier (\$30-50 via DHL/FedEx). Timeline: 7-10 days.
- Lab dip (colored items): If you need custom colors, request lab dips before PPS. Timeline: 5-7 days.
- Shipping sample: A few pieces pulled from the actual production run. Optional but recommended for first orders.

Keep the approved PPS. It's your legal reference if the bulk order doesn't match.

### Step 5: Quality Control -- The Non-Negotiable Step

This is where most buyers who order from an unknown factory lose money. Somebody has to be standing on the line. The standard 3-stage QC process:

- Pre-production inspection: Verify raw materials, fabric rolls, dye lots before cutting. Catch problems at the cheapest stage.
- In-production inspection (DPI): Random check when 20-30% of the order is produced. Check stitching, sizing, color consistency, and fabric feel against your PPS.
- Pre-shipment inspection (PSI): Final random sampling when 80-100% is packed. AQL 2.5 (major defects) / AQL 4.0 (minor defects) is the industry standard for hotel linens.

A detailed QC report with photos and measurements should be standard. If your supplier can't or won't provide this, find another supplier.

### Step 6: Shipping and Logistics

Two primary options for international buyers:

- FOB (Free on Board): You pay the factory for goods + domestic transport to port. You arrange ocean freight and insurance. Cheaper but more work.
- DDP (Delivered Duty Paid): The supplier handles everything door-to-door, including customs clearance and duties. More expensive but zero hassle. Recommended for first-time buyers.

Ocean freight from Shanghai/Ningbo: 25-35 days to US West Coast, 35-45 days to Europe, 15-20 days to Middle East. Air freight: 5-7 days but 4-6x the cost -- only for urgent small orders.

## What to Budget

As of mid-2026, here are approximate FOB price ranges for mid-range hotel quality (not luxury, not budget):

| Product       | Specification                | FOB Price Range        |
|---------------|------------------------------|------------------------|
| Bed Sheet Set | 300TC cotton percale, King   | \$8.50 - \$14.00 / set |
| Duvet Cover   | 300TC cotton sateen, King    | \$10.00 - \$16.00 / pc |
| Bath Towel    | 550 GSM zero-twist, 70x140cm | \$3.50 - \$6.00 / pc   |
| Hand Towel    | 550 GSM, 40x70cm             | \$1.80 - \$3.00 / pc   |
| Bathrobe      | 450 GSM waffle, unisex       | \$8.00 - \$15.00 / pc  |

Add approximately 15-25% for freight, insurance, and customs clearance to get your landed cost.

## Why Order Factory-Direct From Us?

We are a FOB manufacturer alliance -- independent hotel linen export factories in Nantong, next to the Dieshiqiao cluster. Every member owns its own plant and holds its own export licence. Our founding member's 5,000 sqm bedding mill makes the bed sheets, duvet covers and pillowcases, the other members make the towelling, bathrobes, table linen and mattress programmes, and every batch is inspected against one written standard before it ships. You can visit or audit any of them. Sampling, production, QC and export paperwork sit with one team, so no commission layer sits between you and the production line.

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## Ready to Order Factory-Direct Hotel Linens?

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*About Nantong Linens: a FOB manufacturer alliance of independent hotel linen factories based in Nantong, China, adjacent to the Dieshiqiao textile cluster. Every member owns its own plant and its own export licence, and every member accepts a buyer audit or on-site visit. Together we manufacture hotel bed linen, towels, bathrobes and table linen for hotels, distributors and wholesalers worldwide, inspected against one written standard before shipment. Certification and audit documents are available on request.*

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*This guide is for informational purposes only. Prices and lead times are estimates and subject to change.*

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